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Description of the data set

Polish debates on higher education in the Sejm and party manifestos[1]

This dataset contains an analysis of seven Polish parliamentary debates on higher education (HE) and of 41 Polish party manifestos from the period 1989-2021. The parliamentary debates deal with larger higher education reforms (1990, 2001, 2005, 2011, 2018), resolutions on the condition of the HE sector (1995) and the legal package for academic freedom (2021). The party manifestos stem from the largest governing and opposition parties from all legislative periods between 1989 and 2019. The debates and manifestos have been analyzed with a qualitative content analysis with a focus on the governance and redistribution dimension as well as framing of higher education policies.

The analysis of party manifestos contributes to research on the discourse about parties' positioning on HE policies. Scholarship in this field concentrated to date mainly on Western Europe and party systems with a stable left-right cleavage. This analysis shows how the comparatively high number of populist right parties as well as a strong polarization based on cleavages around cultural values can influence debates on HE in post socialist Poland. The analyzed time frame covers different stages in the development of the Polish HE sector. In this period developments such as deindustrialization, the transition from an elite to a mass public model of HE and the introduction of international benchmarks by the OECD took place. Yet, this process took place in a much shorter period of time in Poland than in West European states, while Polish governments also needed to reestablish autonomy of universities after the state-centered governance of higher education and science during socialism. This different political trajectory after WWII in comparison to other countries that are in the focus of research make Poland an interesting case to study the development of debates on HE.

Keywords: Higher Education, Parliamentary Debates, Party Families, Party Manifestos, Poland, Policy Frames, Sejm, Social Policy, Universities

Compilation of the corpus

The Institute of Computer Science of the Polish Academy of Sciences provided access to the relevant parliamentary debates in a txt-format within the CLARIN/ParlaMint-Project

[1] This study has been conducted as part of the joint project "Mod-Block-DDR" by the German Federal Ministry of Education and Research [01UJ1806AY].

(https://www.clarin.eu/parlamint). Responsible contact persons are Maciej Ogrodniczuk and Michał Rudlof.

The party manifestos have been retrieved from various sources: parties' websites, the Comparative Manifesto Project (https://manifestoproject.wzb.eu/), polidoc.net, and several publications from the Institute for Political Studies of the Polish Academy of Sciences:

Słodkowska, I. (Ed.). (2001). Wybory 1991. Programy partii i ugrupowań politycznych

Słodkowska, I. (Ed.). (2001). Wybory 1993. Partie i ich programy.

Słodkowska, I. (Ed.). (2002). Wybory 2001. Partie i ich programy

Słodkowska, I. (Ed.). (2018). Wybory w Wolnej Polsce: Vol. 4. Wybory 2015. Partie i ich programy.

Słodkowska, I. &Dołbakowska, M. (Eds.). (2004). Wybory 1997. Partie i ich programy

Słodkowska, I. & Dołbakowska, M. (Eds.). (2006). Wybory 2005. Partie i ich programy

Słodkowska, I. & Dołbakowska, M. (Eds.). (2013). Wybory w Wolnej Polsce: Vol. 1. Wybory 2011. Partie i ich programy.

Słodkowska, I., Dołbakowska, M. & Cześnik, M. (Eds.). (2011). Wybory 2007: Partie i ich programy.

Description of the corpus

The corpus comprises 7 parliamentary debates and 41 party manifestos which are listed below.

List of parliamentary debates

Debate on	**Date of first reading and of final voting**
HE reform	23.03.1990 12.09.1990
Resolutions on higher education and science from government and parliamentary committee	12.10.1995 13.10.1995
HE reform	21.06.2001 22.06.2001
HE reform (termed 2005 reform)	02.07.2004 03.06.2005
HE reform (termed 2011 reform)	06.10.2010 04.02.2011
HE reform	09.05.2018 03.07.2018
Legal package for academic freedom	29.09.2021 01.10.2021

List of party manifestos

2015 elections
Deklaracja wyborcza PSL. Wybory parlamentarne 2015. Blisko ludzkich spraw
Polska Przyszłości. Program Platformy Obywatelskiej 2015
Program Nowoczesna Polska dla każdego. Wartości. Cele. Działania
Program Prawa i Sprawiedliwości. 2014
Strategia Zmiany. Kukiz'15. Potrafisz Polsko!

2011 elections
Nowoczesna, Solidarna, Bezpieczna Polska. Program Prawa i Sprawiedliwości
PO: Program wyborczy. Następny krok. Razem
RP: Program wyborczy. Nowoczesna Polska
SLD: Jutro bez obaw. Program dla Polski
PSL: Człowiek jest najważniejszy. Program wyborczy

2007 elections
Dbamy o Polskę. Dbamy o Polaków. Program Prawa i Sprawiedliwości.
Polskie Stronnictwo Ludowe. Lista nr 10. Razem tworzymy lepszą przyszłość. Narodowe priorytety PSL na lata 2007 – 2011
Program PO. Polska zasługuje na cud gospodarczy. Platforma Obywatelska. By żyło się lepiej. Wszystkim!
Program wyborczy LEWICY I DEMOKRATÓW. Nowa polityka. Nowa nadzieja.

2005 elections
Deklaracja Wyborcza Sojuszu Lewicy Demokratycznej w wyborach 2005r.
IV Kongres Partii SAMOOBRONA Rzeczypospolitej Polskiej. Program Społeczno-Gospodarczy Samoobrony.
PiS: Program 2005 – IV Rzeczpospolita – sprawiedliwość dla wsyzstkich
Program Platformy Obywatelskiej
Program wyborczy Polskiego Stronnictwa Ludowego
Skrót Programu Gospodarczego Ligi Polskich Rodzin. Dla NIEPODLEGŁEJ Polski oraz SUWERENNEGO Narodu Polskiego

2001 elections
Czas na zmianę … Program społeczno-gospodarczy PSL
Polsce – niepodległość. Polakom - praca, chleb, mieszkania (Program solidaryzmu narodowego Ligi Polskich Rodzin)
PO: Program. 2001 rok
Program Prawa i Sprawiedliwości
Przywrócmy normalność, wygrajmy przyszłość. Program Sojuszu Lewicy Demokratycznej
Tezy Programowe. „Samoobrona RP"

1997 elections
Deklaracja ideowa PSL
Program Akcjii Wyborczej Solidarność
Program Unii Wolności. Wolność. Bezpieczeństwo. Rozwój.
SLD: Dobre dziś - lepsze jutro

1993 elections
Polskie Stronnictwo Ludowe: żywią, bronią, gospodarują. Dokumenty programowe
Przywrócmy nadzieję. Dokument programowy Unii Pracy
Program SLD. Tak dalej być nie może

1991 elections
Deklaracja programowa Porozumienia Obywatelskiego Centrum
Deklaracja wyborcza Sojuszu Lewicy Demokratycznej „Tak dalej być nie musi!"
Odezwa wyborcza Polskiego Stronnictwa Ludowego; Polskie Stronnictwo Ludowe wobec najważnieszych problemów kraju
Partia Chrześcijańskich Demokratów. Program wzborczy.

Tezy programu wyborczego NSZZ „Solidarność“
Z programu Unii Demokratycznej

1989 elections
Deklaracja Wyborcza Polskiej Zjednoczonej Partii Robotniczej
Program Polskiego Stronnictwa Ludowego. Projekt
Program Wyborczy Komitetu Obywatelskiego „Solidarność“. Dlaczego idziemy głosować?“

Coding procedure and coding scheme

Only parliamentary debates with higher education (reforms) as a central topic (as stated in the item of the agenda) have been included into the corpus. All debates are the first reading of a law proposal in the Sejm or the second reading if the first one took place in the parliamentary committee for science, education and youth. Speeches from all governing parties and all opposition parties have been coded. Parliamentary or deputies' clubs (koła parlamentarne and koła poselskie) have been excluded due to their limited number and influence. In party manifestos, the keywords nauka (science), szkolnictwo wyższe (HE), uczelnia (HEI), student and edukacja (education) have been used to find the relevant chapters. In those sections, only statements with references to HE as well as to knowledge-based economies and science policies that can affect HEIs have been analyzed. Neutral descriptions were left out from the analysis and only statements that demand some kind of policy change have been coded.

Every segment could be coded with more than one code. The smallest unit of analysis are parts of sentences, while the biggest units are full passages of a party manifesto. In order to ensure a high degree of validity, the number of coded words is used for the analysis. The coding has been processed manually with the software maxQDA. The student assistants Maja Wielowiejski and David Swierzy supported the coding process. The coding of the student assistants has been double checked (including a test for intercoder reliability) and discussed on a regular basis.

For every code (apart from framing and basic information) the subcategories “strengthen” and “limit” have been added, e. g. strengthen or limit government control of the HE sector.

Coding example from Platforma Obywatelska/ Civic Platform (2007) for the code: Government control of HEIs – Limit

Polish statement: Wpływ państwa na instytucje działające w sektorze wiedzy powinien być stymulujący, ale ograniczony do funkcji regulacyjnych i nadzorczych.

Translation: The state's influence on institutions operating in the knowledge sector should be stimulating but limited to regulatory and supervisory functions.

In the additional category “other” segments that seemed relevant for the dimensions but did not fit with the existing categories were collected and continuously revised.

Accessibility of the file

The file with coded documents is saved in maxQDA (Versions 2020 and 2022). A reader for maxQDA files can be downloaded free of charge from https://www.maxqda.com/products/maxqda-reader. Additionally, the document is saved in the REFI-QDA-format (.qdpx), which allows to open coded documents with different Qualitative Data Analysis programs (https://www.qdasoftware.org/). Please note that document sets, a tool to select several party manifestos simultaneously, can only be displayed in the maxQDA files.

Coding scheme

Group 1: Basic information

The first group of codes provides basic information about the analyzed documents. The researcher is fully aware that not all party manifestos from the investigation period exhibit positions on HE. However, all documents are included the analysis in order to show at which point in time parties develop a position on that policy field. Codes from this group of codes are assigned to the whole speech/party manifesto etc.

Codes	**Definition, Examples**	**Subcode 1**	**Definition, Examples, Polish keywords**
Text format		Party manifesto	Code whole relevant chapter/paragraph in party manifesto
		Speech in Sejm	Code from # to dziekuje (including interjections) Code even when no relevant content in speech
		Question in Sejm	Announced by Sejm marshall Code even when no relevant content in question
		Answer in Sejm	
		Interjection in Sejm	(Seldom), only with direct reference to higher education policies
Party	*As announced by the Sejm Marshal*	New code for every single party	Code in case of no party membership: not attached to any party/ unknown
Name of the speaker	*Not for manifestos, Sejm marshal irrelevant*	New code for every single speaker	Use Polish diacritics
Position of the speaker	*Not for manifestos*	Member of government	
		Member of governing party/parties	

		Member of opposition	Code here also independent MPs
		Civil servant	e.g. from a ministry
		Other	e.g. external experts, president or presidential office

Group 2: Control and redistributive dimension

This group of codes is based on the research design applied by Jungblut (2016) in an analysis of West European party manifestos.[2]

Codes	**Definition, Examples**	**Subcodes 1**	**Subcodes 2**	**Definition, Examples**
Control dimension	The Polish HE system is providing autonomy to HEIs according to the principles of academic self-governance (government control is mostly limited to funding allocation). However, recent reforms have introduced measures of market- and stakeholder-based steering modes. Three following questions are debated: How should the HE sector be governed? How much autonomy, how much government control is	HE autonomy with academic self-governance	Strengthen	Governance by internal actors (senate elected by professors), autonomy of universities, state decides still on funding (often based on input e.g. Student numbers or certain formulas), but not on teaching and research, categorization of HEIS by independent council (quality assurance)
			Limit	
		Government control of HEIs	Strengthen	HE as a governmental instrument for political agendas, government dominant actor in HE, state defines standards for study programmes, admission requirements, attendance requirements in seminars, categorization of HEIS by state agencies, curriculum, duration of studies, research agenda, requirement for academic career (e.g. Habilitation),

[2] Jungblut, J. (2016). Re-distribution and public governance – the politics of higher education in Western Europe. *European Politics and Society*(17 (3)), 331–352. https://doi.org/10.1080/23745118.2016.1140395

	needed? Should universities be organized like enterprises, which need to generate revenue?		Limit	Dual employment at heis, central public exams (in order to ensure equal quality of teaching at different heis
		Market mechanisms in HE governance	Strengthen	"Supermarket mode" university as an enterprises delivers service to society and competes for students and resources: Categorization of heis with limited places in each category, performance-based funding with competitive elements, standardized evaluation and possibility for dismissal of academic staff (profesorowie kontraktowe) in case of negative evaluations at all public heis, standardized evaluation of academic output at all public heis, Governance by one central actor (rector)
			Limit	
		Stakeholder-based steering of HEIs	Strengthen	Governance by different stakeholders (students, academic staff, unions, employers) inside and/or outside heis, state decides on choice of stakeholders
			Limit	
		Other		
Redistributive dimension	How should the HE sector be financed and what needs to be improved?	Public funding	Increase	
			Decrease	
		Tuition fees at public HEIs	In favor	For first study program, depending on context: for second study program or studia niestacjonarne
			Against	
		Financial support for	In favor	E.g. Stypendium socjalne
			Against	

		domestic students		
		Access to HE	Increase	In numbers and required qualifications for different target groups, i.e., more places at universities but also easier access to HEIs (maybe other qualifications than accepted)
			Decrease	
		Other		

Group 3: Inductively developed codes

Codes	**Definition, Examples**	**Subcode 1**	**Definition, Examples,**
Policies focusing on research/science	Policy proposals not related to higher education and careers in research, but concrete research activities	--	--
Particular study programs/ disciplines/ fields of research named in policy proposals	Current debates in Poland show that particular fields of research are not supported by the parties in power (e.g. gender studies or research on the Shoah). Therefore, it will be checked, which study programs, disciplines and fields of research are named directly in policy proposals by which parties. Study programs in other languages than Poland are also included.	Considered important	--

		Considered unimportant	
Labor market orientation of HE	Use of research from HEIs for enterprises, more internships for students, adjust higher education to labor market needs	Increase	--
		Decrease	
Internationalization of HE	Proportion of international students & international academic staff, stays abroad of Polish scholars and students, binational/international research projects with Polish participation Code patriotic rhetoric with “decrease int.”	Increase	--
		Decrease	

Academic Freedom	Code segments if the phrase “wolność akademicka“ is used	--	--
Target groups of HE	Code additionally “Access to HE/increase” when a particular target group is mentioned	Braindrain: Well educated Polish citizens with emigration aspirations	
		Well educated Polish citizens/potential junior researchers	
		Elites (people with perceived privileges)	Wealthy people with easy access to HE because of their family background
		Socio-economic disadvantaged *(because of their personal background)*	
		Rural population	
		Women (Gender equality)	
		National population	e/.g. the whole population needs more education
		People with disabilities	
		Polish minorities in neighboring countries)/Polonia	
		Other	

Group 4: Framing

The last group of codes captures the framing of HE policies used by different parties. Framing, according to Entman (1993), is understood as choosing "some aspects of perceived reality and make them more salient in a communicating text, in such a way as to promote a particular problem definition, causal interpretation, moral evaluation, and/or treatment recommendation for the item described." The codes below show which aspects (target group, involved actors outside HEIs, non-material and material goals) are the major rationales of the different parties when presenting policy proposals. However, the following frames do not exclude each other since some of them can be linked to a new frame.

Frame	**Definition, Examples**
Social policy	access to HE for the whole population as a means for social cohesion and to decrease social inequality and unemployment
Democratization	democratization after communism: education as means for social and political participation, importance of academic freedom
Nation building	Mission of HEIs to transport national values and educate future generations to become citizens with attachment to their country, focus on "Polish" values, potential focus on Polish language
Decommunization	Exchange of elites from People`s Republic of Poland at HEIs
EU accession/cohesion	implementing HE reforms as a (perceived) prerequisite for EU integration, e.g. participation in Bologna Process, need to fulfill EU recommendations after 2004
"Catching up with the West"	HE as a mean to catch up with the economic and political development in EU, OECD and other "Western" states, improving position of Polish HEIs in HE rankings
Utilitarianist/economic perspective	Economic framing: HE as a mean to boost individual/collective productivity and economic growth, HEIs as part of national innovation system and as a location factor
Progress of civilization/serve society	HEIs as means to further develop humankind, civilization, *serve the society*